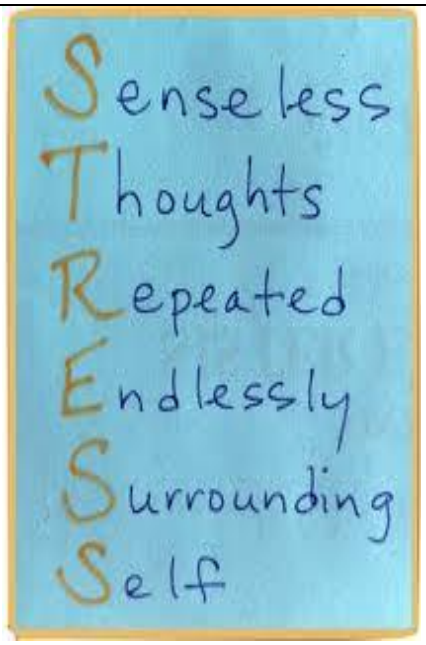
STRESS AND STRESS MANAGEMENTS

Objectives:

At the end of this lecture, the student will be able to:

- Define stress and stressor.
- List kinds of stress.
- List types of stress.
- List sources of stress.
- Mention forms of stressors.
- Enumerate phases of stress response.
- Apply stress management strategies:



Introduction:

Stress may be viewed as an individual's reaction to any change that requires an adjustment or response, which can be physical, mental, or emotional. Responses directed at stabilizing internal biological processes and preserving self-esteem can be viewed as healthy adaptations to stress. Adaptation is viewed as positive and is correlated with a healthy response. When behavior disrupts the integrity of the individual, it is perceived as maladaptive. Maladaptive responses by the individual are negative or unhealthy.

The only person without stress is a dead person" Hans Selye

Definitions:

- Stress is the body's automatic response to any physical or mental demand placed on it.
- Stress typically describes a negative condition that can have an impact on an organism's mental and physical well-being. (Stressors- Positive or Negative
- Adrenaline is a chemical naturally produced in our body as a response to stress.
- Fight or Flight response is elicited.

Stressor: A biological, psychological, social, or chemical factor that causes physical or emotional tension and may be a factor in the etiology of certain illnesses.

Is All Stress Bad?

- Moderate levels of stress may actually improve performance and efficiency
- Too little stress may result in boredom
- Too much stress may cause an unproductive anxiety level

Kinds of stress:

There are different types of stress, good and bad. Most people interpret stress as negative thing, but it doesn't have to be that way. The researchers classify stress into two groups, the good stress or 'Eustress' or the bad stress or 'Distress'

1-positive stress (Eustress)

2- negative stress (Distress)

Eustress or positive stress occurs when the level of stress is high enough to motivate the person to move into action to get things accomplished; e.g. (getting ready for the exam)

Distress or negative stress occurs when stress gets out of hand, it becomes bad stress or distress, which will bring out the weakness within us and make us vulnerable to fatigue and illness.

- Positive stress • Motivates, focuses energy • Is short-term • Is perceived as within our coping abilities • Feels exciting • Improves performance	**2- negative stress** has • Causes anxiety or concern • Can be short or long-term • Is perceived as outside of our coping abilities • Feels unpleasant • Decreases performance • Can lead to mental and physical problems

Sources of stress:

- **The Environment** –include weather, noise, crowding, pollution, traffic, unsafe and crime.
- **Social Stressors** –include, financial problems, job interviews, presentations, disagreements,

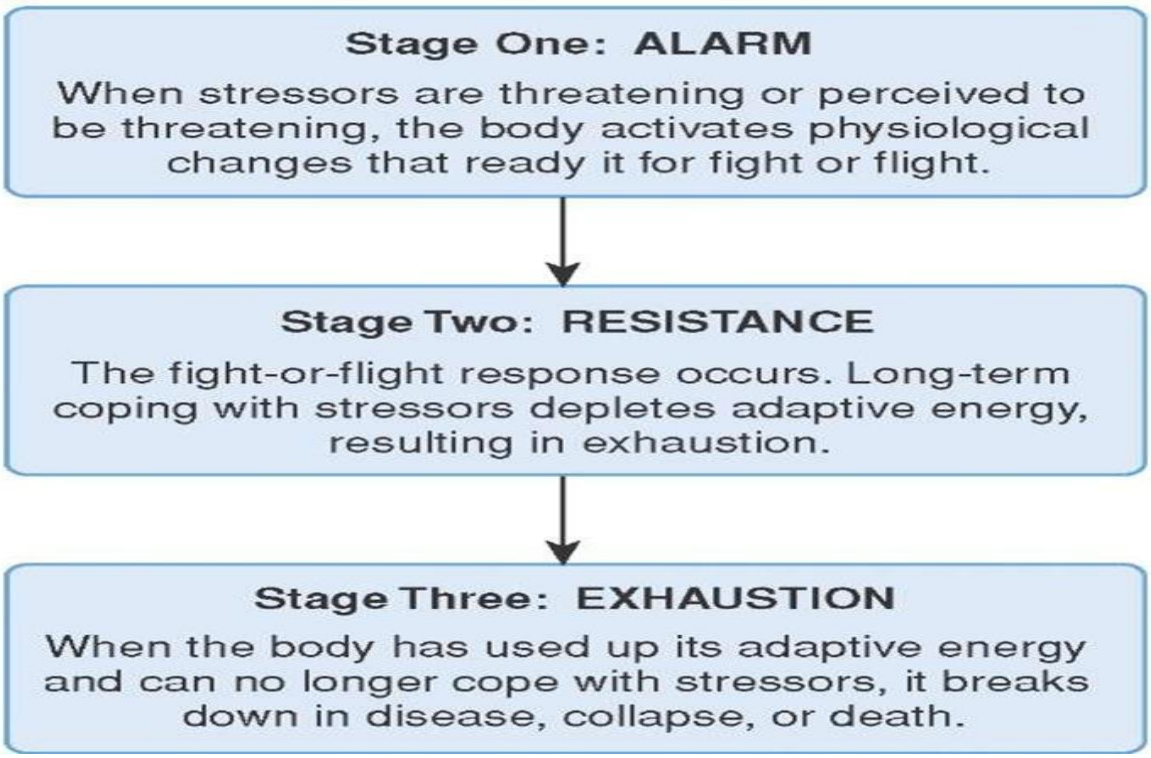
- **Physiological** include rapid growth of adolescence,
- menopause, illness, aging, and sleep disturbances.
- **Thoughts** – Your brain interprets and perceives situations as stressful, difficult, painful.

Forms of stressors

Internal stressors	External stressors
Physiological: illness, lack of sleep, lack of nutrition, pain, surgery, caffeine consumption, lack of relaxation **Emotional** loss of loved person, death, divorcing, family problem, financial problem	**Environmental** heat, noise, crowding **others** Work problems Time pressure

Response-based model

Hans Selye's stress response is characterized by a chain or pattern of physiologic events called the general adaptation syndrome (GAS). If the stress is extreme or long standing, the normal me\chanisms may not be sufficient. This case, the stress triggers a wide – ranging set of bodily changes called general adaptation syndrome.



The person response to stress consists of three stages:

1. Alarm or fight-or flight (a threat is perceived, the body responds physiologically

2. Resistance (coping mechanisms are used to try reestablishing homeostasis.

3. Exhaustion (occurs if homeostasis is not achieved)

Negative Effects of Stress

1. Physical
   - Weight gain/loss
   - Sweaty palms
   - • Muscle tension
   - Flushed cheeks
   - Unexpected hair loss
   - Heart palpitations
   - High blood pressure•
   - Light headedness

2. Emotional
   - Mood swings
   - Anxiety
   - Can lead to depression
   - Can also lead to unhealthy coping strategies (i.e. alcohol, drugs, etc)
   - Nervous
   - Irritable
   - Anxious
   - Panicky

3. Behavioral Symptoms:
   - Eating more or less
   - Sleeping too much or too little
   - Isolating yourself from others
   - Procrastinating or neglecting responsibilities
   - Using alcohol, cigarettes, or drugs to relax
   - Nervous habits (nail biting, pacing)
   - Avoiding situations where experiencing anxiety might occur
   - Leaving situations when feelings of anxiety begin to occur
   - Trying to do things perfectly or trying to control events to prevent danger

4. Thoughts:

- Overestimation of danger
- Underestimation of your ability to cope
- Underestimation of help available
- Worries and catastrophic thoughts

Stress management:

It is partly a collection of procedures for helping people cope with or reduce stress already being experienced.

Adaptive coping strategies in the management of stress

The term coping is used to refer to the process by which person attempts to manage stressful demands.

Coping Resources

Defense Techniques
Social Support (material, and emotional support)
Motivation
Problem solving and social skills
Knowledge and intelligence
Positive beliefs, physical health , wellbeing and energy
Culture Stability
Strong ego identity

Stress Relief Strategies

1. Body relaxation exercises
   - breathing techniques
   - guided imagery
2. Physical exercise
   -yoga
   -workout routine
3. Meditation: Practiced 20 minutes once or twice daily. It involves assuming a comfortable position, closing the eyes, casting off all other thoughts, and concentrating on a single word, sound, or phrase that has positive meaning to the individual.
4. Counseling
   -talk therapy

-life coaching

Problem Solving

An extremely adaptive coping strategy is to view the situation objectively. After an objective assessment of the situation, the problem-solving/decision-making model can be instituted as follows:

- Assess the facts of the situation.
- Formulate goals for resolution of the stressful situation.
- Study the alternatives for dealing with the situation.
- Determine the risks and benefits of each alternative.
- Select an alternative.
- Implement the alternative selected.
- Evaluate the outcome of the alternative implemented.
- If the first choice is ineffective, select and implement a second option

Other Helpful tips

- Changing perceptions and expectations
- Break jobs/tasks into manageable parts
- Set reasonable/realistic goals
- Avoid procrastination
- Set boundaries
- Don't compromise your values/beliefs
- Schedule "me" time

Music

Creating and listening to music stimulate motivation, enjoyment, and relaxation. Music can reduce depression and bring about measurable changes in mood and general activity.

Time management- a key to reduce work stress

Schedule a timetable

Prioritize your work

Learn to say no

Assign time for each activity

Put a "do not disturb" sign

Avoid distractions

Get organized

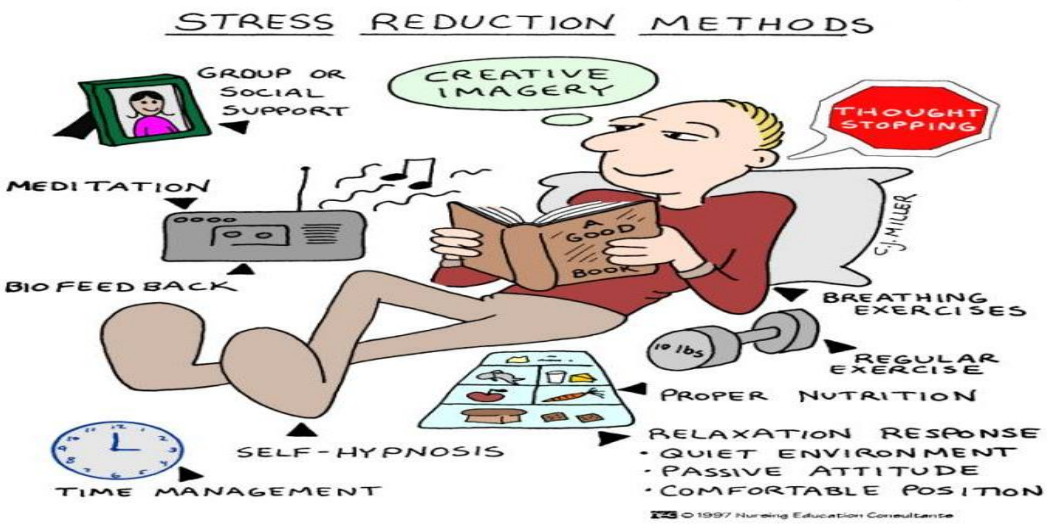
Get structured

Set short term goals

Set long term goals

Use a planner:
daily schedule and “To Do” list

Cognitive (Thoughts)
Pay attention to what you say to yourself
Identify negative thinking and irrational beliefs
Negative thinking leads to stress and anxiety
Teach thought-stopping techniques
Teach affirmations

Benefits of Stress Management

- Physical health gets better
- More energy and stamina
- Emotions stabilized
- Positive attitude
- hopeful/happier
- Ability to focus improved
- Able to learn and achieve